PENNY TRISTRAM



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ABOUT ME

Artist, educator and facilitator.

I oversee the arts and crafts department at Machspace, which is a makerspace in mid-Wales. Machspace serves over 100 members with a 24-hour accessible 3rd space, with 3D printer, laser cutter, woodworking, art and fibrecraft tools and materials.

I co-founded and ran Hens with Pens, a national life drawing agency that has brought fun and inspiration to many thousands of parties across the UK for the last 9 years. Hens with Pens has won several industry awards and appeared on Prof. Mary Beard's BBC2 series "Art of the Nude."

I Co-founded Stiwdios Y Plas Studios, a shared working studio and workshop space in Machynlleth, Wales.

I secured Arts Council funding for and created the research and development project Old Mistress, reinterpreting paintings by pre-20th Century women painters as embroideries. The project saw me working collaboratively with a project manager, mentors and fellow artists/researchers.

QUALIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

2023- Teaching in Prisons training, University of the Arts, London

2023-Compassionate Assessment, Thinking Teaching, and Anti-Racism Training, University of the Arts, London.

2021- MA Illustration, Falmouth University. Merit.

2006- BA Drawing, Camberwell College of Arts, University of the Arts, London. 2:1.

TEACHING/EVENTS

2023-2024
Arts and Crafts Coordinator at Machspace CIC. My role at Machspace sees me teaching and facilitating in a range of skills including sewing, embroidery, woodwork, and fine art. I am also responsible for managing materials and supplies. One of the most enjoyable parts of my role is connecting individuals with specific knowledge, and seeing projects develop. I am a director of Machspace and jointly responsible for legal and budget decisions as well as fundraising.

2022-2023 Associate Lecturer in transmedia and subvertising. BA Advertising, BA media communications, BA Contemporary Media Cultures, BA Public Relations. London College of Communication, University of the Arts, London.

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TEACHING/EVENTS CONTINUED

I designed and delivered a module across four undergraduate disciplines. Using group facilitation, discussion moderation, research, and practical skills including video production, Adobe Creative Suite, and media collage, students worked in groups to create a subvertising campaign. I successfully raised the morale and confidence of the cohort, leading to all students passing with grades between A+ and C-.

Three of the students' practical work were forwarded by the course leader to the university communications team as examples of outstanding work with a view to feature in its marketing materials.

2022 Visiting Lecturer MA Fine Art, Falmouth University.
I created a video lecture about the intersection of creative practice and neurodivergence/disability.

2021 Drawing Workshop Leader - 'Mapio Sain Ein 5 Milltir Sgwar'/'Soundmapping our 5 Square Miles'

2018-2024 - Owner at Hens with Pens

2014- 2018. Life drawing tutor and partner CEO at Hens with Pens

2012-2014 Life drawing tuition for groups including Girl Guides, Womens' Institute, hen parties, and private classes.

SELECTED EXHIBITIONS

SOLO

AN ART GALLERY YOU CAN HOLIDAY IN - Machynlleth - August/September 2023

Hamilton House – Artist of the Month exhibition - Bristol – February 2014

TWO PERSON

TY AGORED HAF/SUMMER OPEN HOUSE - Machynlleth - June 2023

PWYTHO PENNOD/STITCH STORIES - Machynlleth - August 2021

GROUP

IT WON'T LAST - NEITH O'M PARA - Machynlleth August 2023

What Art You Laughing At – Yinka Shonibare Guest Projects, London – March 2016

SELECTED AWARDS

Honourable Mention – Visionary Art Collective / Finding Sanctuary - March 2021

Second Prize – ArtKudos International Juried Exhibition August 2013 Pikachu: http://www.artkudos.com/2013/awards.html - prize $1000. Pikachu was also featured by the Guardian newspaper.